Saturday, February 25

Political religions of the extreme left or extreme right—and even more so, religious-messianic regimes—function according to dynamics of their own, dynamics that know only the impact of increasing speed, until they destroy themselves or are destroyed by superior force.

In Israel, the regime set up by Netanyahu and his allies is a typical messianic one, a mixture of extreme nationalism and extreme religiosity, with added clannish and personal interests. Both tendencies were present from the very beginnings of Zionism, overshadowed for decades by the battle to establish the state, external threats, ordinary politics, and a struggling economy. The fanatics were well known and active on the scene (the rabbis Kook—Abraham Isaac Kook and his son Zvi Yehuda Kook—and their disciples on the religious side: Geulah Cohen, Yuval Ne'eman, Rehavam Zeevi, and multifaceted Sharon on the nationalist one), but their impact seemed minimal, as strong personalities and seemingly strong political parties were in the saddle.

Then came 1967, followed by 1977 and 1995. Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin's murder by the religious-nationalist Yigal Amir after the two Oslo Accords between Israel and Arafat's Palestinian Liberation Organization brought forth a strong reaction, but a subterranean fire of fanaticism was burning, cleverly stirred up by politicians such as Netanyahu (for his own interests). Now the results are in.

The Israeli fanatics will not slow down on their own. What could be the outside agent bringing them to an unexpected stop? You might have expected some forceful intervention by President Biden, but that will not happen. As for the Israeli opposition, it is too polite, too civilized. Thus, nobody can see the end of this avalanche, except through the intervention of an act of God … Isn't it grotesque that an atheist like me should ask for an act of God against our army of religious fanatics?